

Email Marketing Basics for Craft Sellers

Why Email Beats Social Media

You own your email list. Social media platforms can change their algorithm, reduce your reach, or disappear entirely. Your email list is yours — it's the most reliable channel you have for reaching people who already want to hear from you.

Getting Started: Choose a Platform

Mailchimp — Free up to 500 contacts, easy to use, good templates.

MailerLite — Free up to 1,000 contacts, cleaner design, better automation on free plan.

Klaviyo — More powerful, better for e-commerce integrations, free up to 250 contacts.

For most craft businesses starting out: **MailerLite**.

Building Your List

- Add a sign-up form to your website — offer a free resource or a discount as an incentive
- At craft markets, have a clipboard or QR code to sign-up page
- Mention your newsletter in your social media bios
- Add new customers from your shop to your list (with their permission)

What to Send

Aim for one email per month to start. Here's a simple structure that works:

Subject line: Specific and personal. "New autumn collection — first look" beats "Newsletter #12"

Opening: 2–3 sentences about what's happening in your studio right now.

Main content: New products, an upcoming market, a behind-the-scenes story, or a useful tip.

Call to action: One clear link — "Shop the new collection", "Book a workshop", "Download the free guide".

Subject Lines That Work

- "Just finished: [product name]"
- "You asked for it — [product] is back"

- "[Name], your [season] collection is here"

The One Rule That Matters

Be consistent. Monthly beats brilliant-but-irregular. Your subscribers need to expect and recognise you before they'll buy from you.